went back and forth between allegiance to their peers and loyalty to the king; Henry's oldest son and heir, Edward, at first took a virtuously principled stance of disagreement with his father (refusing, says Paris, "to accept of or profit by this absolution") and then reversed himself, made up with Henry III, and became the leader of the royal army.[12]

In the summer of 1263, Simon de Montfort began to agitate, openly, for armed resistance. By March 1264, the two armies—the barons behind Montfort, the royalists led by Prince Edward—had advanced towards each other and lay only nineteen miles apart. Raids, skirmishes, and plundering of nearby estates began.

On May 14, the armies met at Lewes, on the southern coast of England. Edward, in charge of one wing of the attack, crushed the barons facing him and chased them well into the countryside. But the rest of the royal army faltered. By the time Edward returned, Henry III had surrendered after his horse was killed underneath him, and the royal forces had scattered.

Edward too was forced to surrender. Montfort, leader of the baronial cause, was now the most powerful man in England. He put Edward and Henry under courteous guard, in the Tower of London. "From that time," Paris records, "he showed himself less inclined to treat for peace . . . because he had the king and the whole kingdom in his power." For fifteen months, the monarchy remained under his control.[13]

Early in 1265, Edward managed to talk his guards into allowing him to ride outside the city gates for exercise. When they agreed, he challenged them to a race, and then quickly outrode them and took refuge with royal partisans at the castle of Wigmore. He found plenty of support for the royal cause outside of London: "Thus released from his imprisonment," Paris says, "Edward assembled a large army, as numbers flocked to join him." The war began again. Clashes in July and early August both ended with Simon de Montfort's army driven backwards. In the third encounter between the two forces, at the field of Evesham on August 4, Edward's army massacred the opposition in a brief violent two-hour confrontation. Simon de Montfort himself died in the fighting.[14]